

Team Building and Icebreaker Activities



Overview & Guidelines

As we continue to embody our Core Values to Inspire Amazing Experiences, Deliver Exceptional Values, your Learning & Development team has created and prepared this Team Building and Icebreaker Activity Resource Guide for you to engage, connect, and get to know your team members while enhancing skills and competencies.

This resource guide contains 20 team building and/or ice-breaking activities along with instructions for each of them. This resource guide is also available on the UKG Home Page under “Teambuilding Resources.”

Team Building and Icebreaker Activities Definition

Team Building Activities: Team-building activities are games, meetings, activities or events designed to motivate members of a group to get to know, bond and build respect for one another. Team building activities focus on making a group become more cohesive.

Icebreaker Activities: Icebreakers are quick activities designed to help employees get to know each other and usually involve sharing names and other background information.

Guidelines

- Identify if the team would need a team building or an icebreaker activity based on the definition given above.
- Review the table and the list of activities on the next slide to decide which would address your team’s needs.
- Schedule the activities during work hours.
- If you plan to conduct the activity face-to-face, make sure to prepare a venue, as needed, ahead of time.
- Read the activity details and prepare the activity materials in advance.
- Before facilitating an activity, explain the intent for conducting it. Encourage collaboration, not competition.
- If you have any questions or support needed, please reach out to your respective **HR Business Partners**.

Team Building and Icebreaker Activities

Both: F2F or Virtual	Both: F2F or Virtual	Face-to-Face ONLY
<u>Team Building Activities:</u> • 10 in Common • Best Piece of Advice • Building a Storyline • Desert Island Intelligences • Draw, Partner • Sweet Stories • The Compliment Circle	<u>Icebreaker Activities:</u> • 10 in Common • Best Piece of Advice • Guess Who • My N.A.M.E • New Leader Assimilation • Office Bingo • Office Trivia • Personal Artifact • Scattergories • Sweet Stories • Two Truths and One Lie • Wolf/Chicken/Grain Riddle	<u>Team Building Activities:</u> • A Shrinking Vessel • Scavenger Hunt • Team Jigsaw Puzzle • The Marshmallow Activity

**click on the name of the activity for details*

My N.A.M.E

Overview: An activity in which participants introduce themselves by presenting their first names as acronyms

Competency/Skill Target: Team Engagement

Time to Complete: 10 to 15 minutes

Meeting Type: Face-to-Face or Virtual

Category: Icebreaker

Instructions:

- Give the group 5 minutes to think of interesting facts about themselves that correspond to the letters of their first name.
- Have each participant share his or her acronym.
- For example... “Hi, I’m Logan. **L** is for Led Zepplin, one of my favorite rock groups. **O** is for Ohio, which is where I live. **G** is for German, the only foreign language I know. **A** is for Aunt Wendee, my favorite relative. And **N** is for Nice, because I am a nice guy!”



Sweet Stories

Overview: An activity in which participants share a story about themselves based on the color of the candy they have in their hands.

Competency/Skill Target: Trust, Building Relationships

Time to Complete: 15 to 20 minutes

Material/s needed: Colored M&Ms, Starburst or jellybeans

Meeting Type: Face-to-Face or Virtual

Category: Team Building or Icebreaker

Instructions:

- Take turns sharing with the group a story based on the following code:
- **Blue candy:** A time at work when you felt very proud.
- **Green candy:** A boss you respected and why.
- **Yellow candy:** A reason you are proud to belong to this organization.
- **Brown candy:** A work experience that stands out to you.
- **Orange candy:** A time at work when a project or task didn't go as planned.
- **Red candy:** A funny thing that happened to you at work.
- Each participant will be given 2 minutes to share their stories.



The Compliment Circle

Overview: To foster a culture of appreciation by encouraging team members to provide positive feedback for each other

Competency/Skill Target: Teamwork, Communication, Feedback

Time to Complete: 15 minutes

Material/s needed: Pens and Post-it Notes

Meeting Type : Face-to-Face or Virtual

Category: Team Building

Instructions:

Team members will spend 10 minutes writing compliments for each team member.

- This activity is good for groups of 4-8 people.
- Each team member will take turns being the compliment receiver. Each team member will share the compliment written for the compliment receiver.
- The compliment receiver cannot respond to the compliments other than to say, “thank you”.
- Compliments can be one word or 1-2 sentences.

Building a Storyline

Overview: Team members will complete a story by completing another person's sentence. Through this activity, participants can enhance their listening skills and collaboration.

Competency/Skill Target: Teamwork, Listening

Time to Complete: 15 minutes

Meeting Type : Face-to-Face or Virtual

Category: Team Building

Instructions:

- Arrange participants in a circle or create sequence who would go after each other.
- One team member starts narrating a story but stops with an incomplete sentence.
- For example, "Jane was on her way to the office. She stopped at the local coffee shop to..."
- The next person finishes the sentence and adds another incomplete sentence.
- This goes on until the final person in the circle does the same.

Draw, Partner

Overview: Partners will draw a picture using only the other's instructions. Through this activity, team members can learn to give clear instructions, ask follow-up questions and decipher directions with little outside information.

Competency/Skill Target: Listening, Asking probing questions

Time to Complete: 15 minutes

Materials needed: Photos - click [here](#)

Meeting Type : Face-to-Face or virtual

Category: Team Building

Instructions:

Split the group into pairs. Instruct each pair to stand with their backs to each other

- Give one partner a pen and paper, and the other a drawing/photo.
- Direct the partner with the drawing to describe the picture to the other partner, who will draw the object.
- Each pair will be given 3 minutes to complete their drawing
- Reveal the artwork and gauge the accuracy. ***What would have made the instructions clearer? What would the communicator have done differently, if anything?***
- Direct partners to switch roles and repeat the activity with a new picture.

Office Trivia

Overview: To test team members on how well they know the company, their leaders, etc.

Competency/Skill Target: Teamwork, Business Acumen

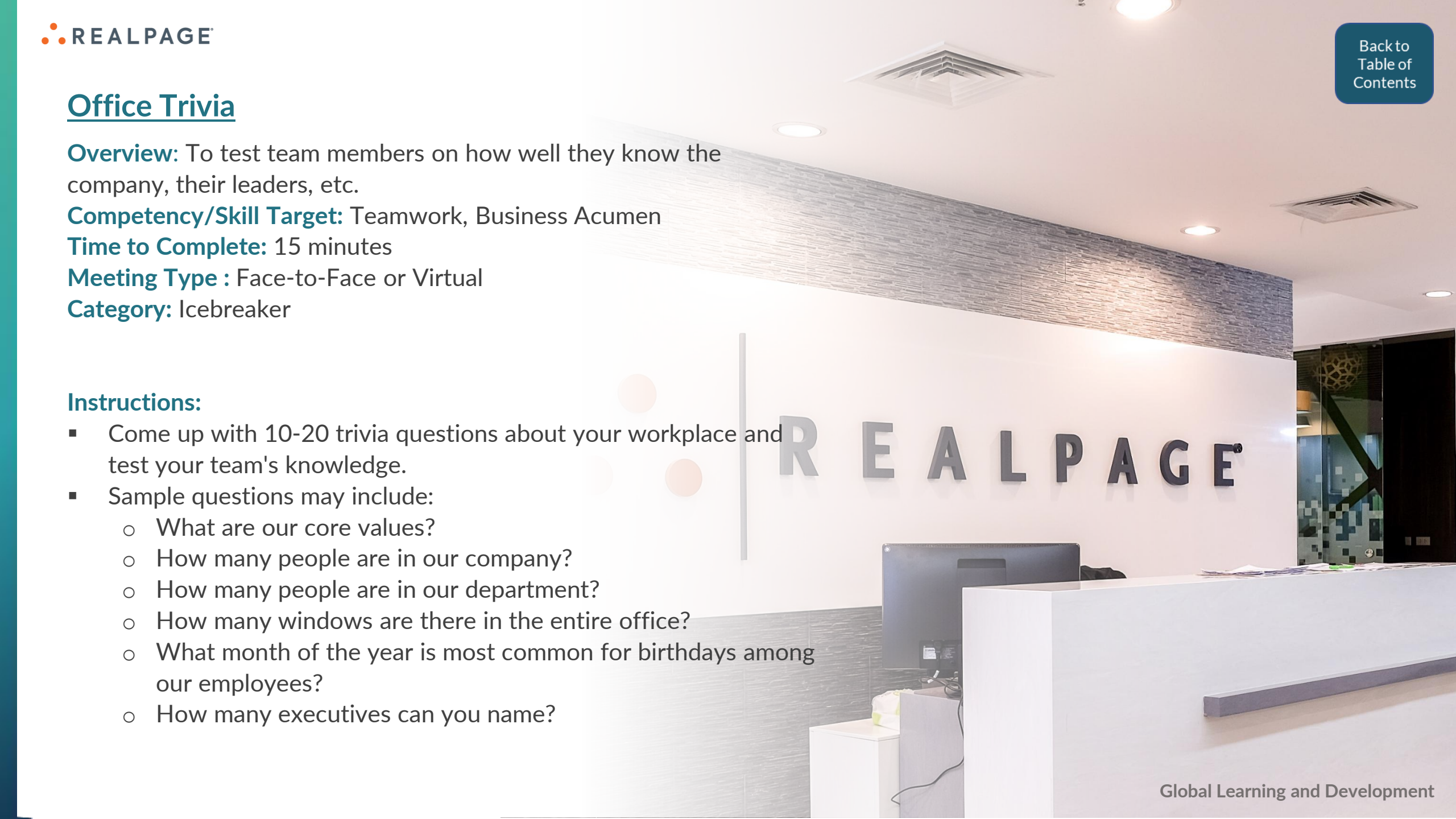
Time to Complete: 15 minutes

Meeting Type : Face-to-Face or Virtual

Category: Icebreaker

Instructions:

- Come up with 10-20 trivia questions about your workplace and test your team's knowledge.
- Sample questions may include:
 - What are our core values?
 - How many people are in our company?
 - How many people are in our department?
 - How many windows are there in the entire office?
 - What month of the year is most common for birthdays among our employees?
 - How many executives can you name?



REALPAGE

Two Truths and One Lie

Overview: Team member to share hobbies, interest or incident to get know your teammates and/or participants of the event.

Competency/Skill Target: Team Engagement, Creative Thinking, Decision-making

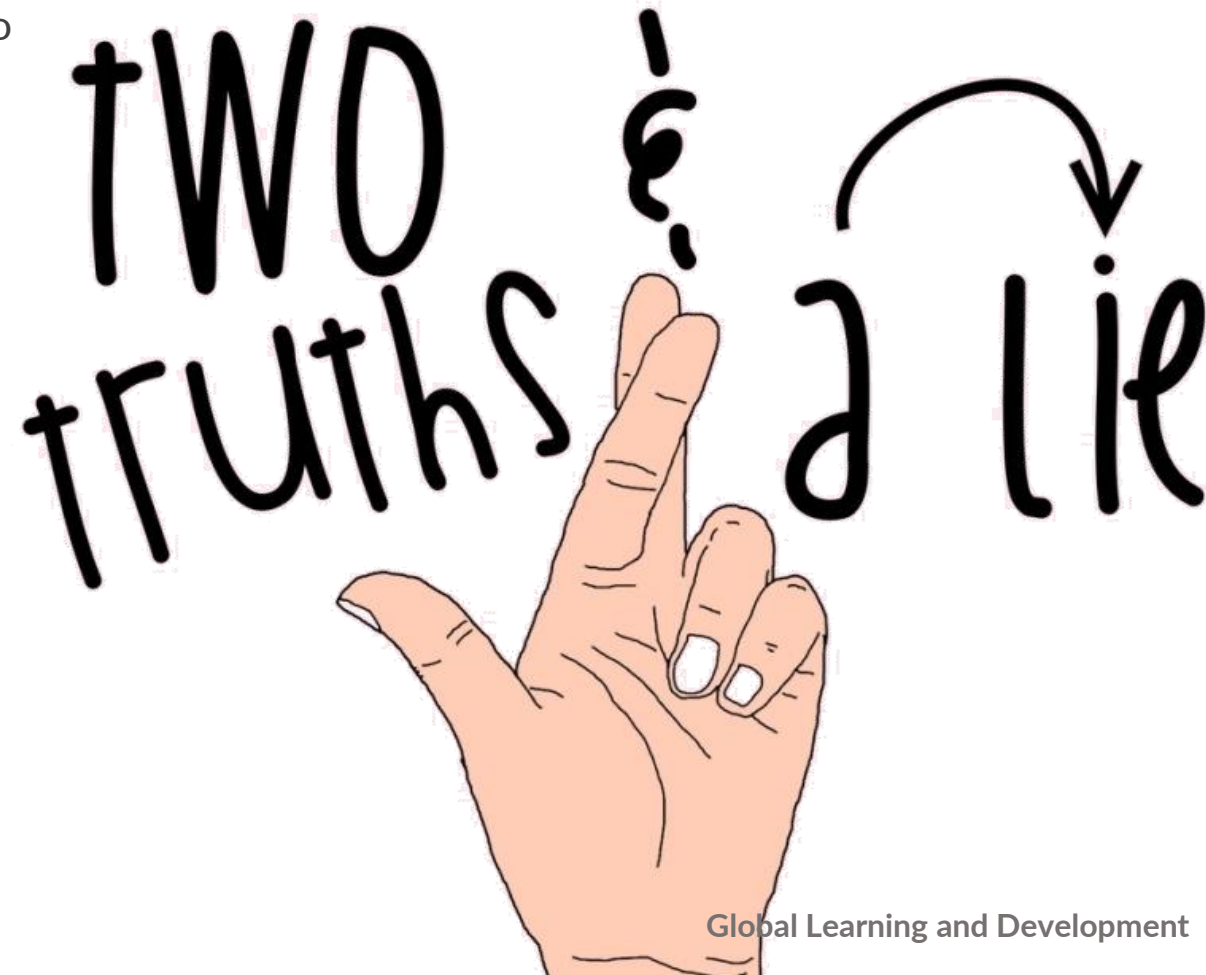
Time to Complete: 10 minutes

Meeting Type : Face-to-Face or Virtual

Category: Icebreaker

Instructions:

- Have each participant share three statements about themselves, 2 facts (truths) and one lie.
- Team members must guess which statement is the lie.



Scavenger Hunt

Overview: Scavenger hunts can be great for a team to get to know more about the chosen topic, requiring them to identify things around the office. Employees work together as a team and explore the office.

Competency/Skill Target: Teamwork, Problem Solving, Critical Thinking

Time to Complete: 15 minutes

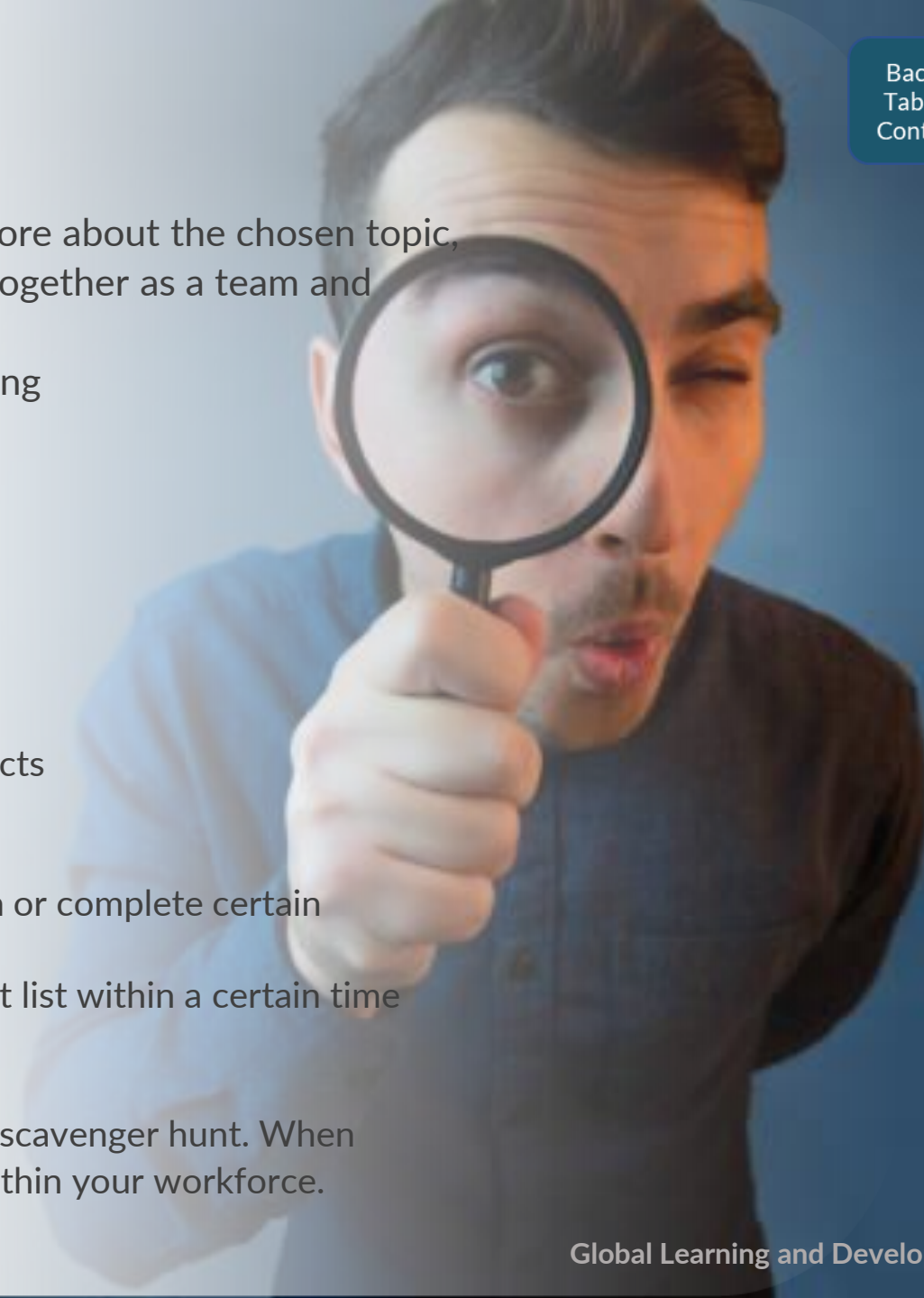
Material/s needed: Mobile phones

Meeting Type : Face-to-Face

Category: Team Building

Instructions:

- Set up questions for employees to uncover X number of facts or artifacts
- Divide players into small teams and define a starting location
- Each team is given a starting clue or challenge to complete
- Employees will have to find items hidden around a predefined location or complete certain challenges.
- Make it each team's mission to find and photograph everything on that list within a certain time limit
- The first team to complete each item on the list wins
- Be creative with the items, challenges, and riddles you include in your scavenger hunt. When thinking of challenges, consider key skills you would like to develop within your workforce.



The Marshmallow Activity

Overview: The objective of this activity is for groups to see who can build the tallest, freestanding structure using uncooked spaghetti and marshmallows. This activity requires collaboration from participants in a short time frame. It can reveal lessons about the nature of collaboration, teamwork, etc.

Competency/Skill Target: Teamwork, Problem Solving, Critical Thinking, Change Management

Time to complete: 20 minutes

Material/s needed:

- Package of uncooked spaghetti noodles per team (not thin)
- 1 bag of marshmallows per team (large is okay)
- Measuring tape

Meeting Type : Face-to-Face

Category: Team Building

Instructions:

- This activity is best for larger groups.
 - Teams can be 3-8 people.
- Hand out the package of spaghetti and marshmallows to each table and give these instructions:
 - Build the tallest freestanding structure using only the items that were handed out.
 - Set timer for 10 minutes.
 - Start timer – Go!
- Measure towers at the end
- Declare a winner based on the tallest structure
- Debrief the activity. Suggested questions:
 - What general observations did you notice as you were building the tower?
 - What strengths emerged as you helped to build the tower?
 - Who within your group stood out? Why?
 - What kind of communication was going on?
 - Did anyone take charge? How? What did they do?
 - Was anyone left out?
 - If you could redo the exercise, what would you do differently?
- Additional variations to this activity may include:
 - Provide an additional resource mid-way through building the tower. Example: Scotch tape.
 - Rotate team members mid-way through building this tower. This can represent team members leaving, adding new team members, and/or change management.

New Leader Assimilation

Overview: This activity includes a list of questions that a team can ask to get to know a new leader.

Competency/Skill Target: Teamwork, Communication, Leadership Style and Expectations

Time to complete: 1-2 hours, depending on the size of the team and number of questions.

Meeting Type : Face-to-Face or Virtual

Category: Icebreaker

Instructions:

- 1-2 months into a new leader assignment, a facilitator asks for questions from the leader's direct reports – both personally and professionally. These can be asked for and collected in advance or flip-charted in person. **Note:** the new leader is not included as a participant for this part.
- The leader then comes in to answer questions provided by the facilitator that were “anonymously” posed to get to know the leader and the leader's style.



Best Piece of Advice

Overview: This activity is for team members to get to know each other by sharing their best piece of advice and why is important to them.

Competency/Skill Target: Teamwork, Communication

Time to complete: 10-15 minutes

Meeting Type : Face-to-face or Virtual

Category: Team Building or Icebreaker

Instructions:

- Ask each participant to think about the best piece of advice you have been given.
- Participants take turns sharing advice, why it is important to them and how they have applied it.
- Flipchart advice for the team.

10 in Common

Overview: This activity is for team members to get to know each other better by finding unique commonalities. This is most impactful for teams with a lot of new people or for groups that don't interact/work with each other often.

Competency/Skill Target: Teamwork, Communication, Building Relationships

Time to Complete: 20 minutes

Meeting Type : Face-to-Face or Virtual

Category: Icebreaker or Team Building

Instructions:

- Break group into teams, mix teams by work group/role type.
- Task each team to come up with 10 things they have in common (exclude "we are human," "we all work at RealPage," etc).
- Bring the teams back together and ask each team to share how many things they found in common and their top 3 unique commonalities.

Personal Artifact

Overview: The objective of this activity is for team members to gain further understanding of what someone finds meaningful. This works best for groups of 10 – 25 people.

Competency/Skill Target: Building Relationships

Time to Complete: 15 minutes

Meeting Type : Face-to-Face or Virtual

Category: Ice Breaker

Instructions:

- Ask each person in the group to pick an item they currently have with them and explain what significance or memory it holds for them. People can use something they are wearing, anything in their pockets/purse, a notebook, water bottle, etc.
- If time allows the group can ask 2-3 questions about each artifact.



Team Jigsaw Puzzle

Overview: Team members will work together to complete a puzzle in the allotted time but will have to find and barter for their missing pieces.

Competency/Skill Target: Teamwork, Communication, Problem Solving, Negotiation

Time to Complete: 25 – 30 minutes

Material/s needed: Puzzles (100 pieces)

Meeting Type : Face-to-Face

Category: Team Building

Instructions:

- Before the game begins take a few pieces of each puzzle and put them in a different puzzle box
- Divide group into same-sized teams and give each team a different jigsaw puzzle with the same number of pieces (recommend 100 pieces).
- The goal is to finish a completed puzzle first – they will work collectively to figure out how to convince other teams to give up the pieces they need. They can barter, merge/change teams, donate minutes, or come up with creative problem-solving methods.

Wolf/Chicken/Grain Riddle

Overview: Teams work together to solve a riddle (within a given timeframe) and explain their reasoning to the larger group. Works best for a smaller group – no more than 20 people.

Competency/Skill Target: Critical Thinking, Problem Solving

Time to Complete: 20 minutes (10 to solve riddle, 10 to present/discuss)

Meeting Type: Face-to-Face or Virtual

Category: Icebreaker

Instructions:

- Divide group into teams of 3 – 5 people.
- Give the group the riddle: “A farmer is traveling with a wolf, chicken, and bag of grains comes to a river they need to cross. The boat only has room for the farmer and 1 other. The farmer can’t leave the wolf alone with the chicken and he can’t leave the chicken alone with the grain. How can he get them all across the river safely?”
- Teams have 10 minutes to figure out their solution.
- Ask each team to present their solution to the group and what method they used to solve the riddle.
 - Points to consider: did one person take charge? Did anyone draw/map out the solution? Did they come to a consensus? Who was familiar with the riddle and remembered it from previous experience?
- Answer to riddle:
 - The farmer takes the chicken over first. He brings the wolf second and comes back with the chicken. He drops off the chicken and takes the grain to the other side with the wolf. The farmer makes one last trip to retrieve the chicken.



Desert Island Intelligences

Overview: Based on [Gardner's Theory of Multiple Intelligences](#), this game asks your team to vote people off a deserted island based on how useful they believe different skillsets/interests would be for survival.

Competency/Skill Target: Communication, Persuasion, Critical Thinking

Time to Complete: 1 hour

Meeting Type: Face-to-face or Virtual

Category: Team Building

Instructions:

- Ask 8 team members to represent one of the eight intelligences (for larger groups you can have 2-3 people represent each one) the remaining group members will be the voting audience. The eight intelligences include:
 - Visual-spatial
 - Linguistic-verbal
 - Interpersonal
 - Intrapersonal
 - Logical-mathematical
 - Musical
 - Body-kinesthetic
 - Naturalistic
- Provide each of the eight people/teams [information](#) on their assigned intelligence.
- Give each intelligence team 5 minutes to prepare their argument.
- Each intelligence team will present their argument as to how they can help further society on the island and ensure survival for the larger group.
- The voting group will listen to each argument/presentation and must come to a consensus on what order to eliminate the intelligences in, to ensure survival and prosperity for their new island community.
- Allow for debate and discussion across the group.

A Shrinking Vessel

Overview: This activity will help avoid having a teammate fall off the circle and work together to figure out how to keep everyone within the shrinking boundaries.

Competency/Skill Target: Teamwork, Critical Thinking and Problem Solving

Time to Complete: 15- 20 minutes

Materials Needed: A rope

Meeting Type : Face-to-Face

Category: Team Building

Instructions:

- Using the rope, make a shape on the floor where everyone can fit into.
- Then gradually shrink the space by reducing the size of the shape, so the team will have to think fast and work together to keep everyone within the shrinking boundaries.



Office Bingo

Overview: In this activity, the facilitator reads out loud the statements one by one on the bingo card shared with team members, and then they cross off, or not, their square.

Competency/Skill Target: Team Engagement, Integrity, and Decision-making

Time to Complete: 25-30 minutes

Materials Needed: Bingo Card Print out

Meeting Type : Face-to-Face or Virtual

Category: Icebreaker

Instructions:

- Generate and email the bingo cards just before the meeting.
- Players need to download or hand over print out of Bingo cards during meeting.
- One by one, call out the statements on the virtual bingo card. Each time a statement is called out, if the team member recognizes it, they must cross it off their virtual bingo card.
- Let each virtual team member have the opportunity to share their experiences, jokes, and stories about the topic on the bingo card. This will get the team to have a good laugh and connect.
- The bingo winner is the first person who successfully crosses off an entire column, row or diagonal line.
- Motivate the team with funny dares, example the loser will have to sing a song in the next team meeting.
- See sample of the Office Bingo card on the side.



Guess Who

Overview: Looking at images, team members need to guess their teammates who submitted those images.

Competency/Skill Target: Team Engagement, Building Relationships and Observational Skills

Time to Complete: 15-20 minutes

Meeting Type : Face-to-Face or virtual

Category: Icebreaker

Instructions:

- Have your team members send a photo of their home offices.
- Share the image on screen and then have everyone do the guess work.
- Keep the game going with photos of everyone's coffee mugs, desktop backgrounds, or the view outside their window, favorite quote, their lunch that day etc.
- The one who guesses all the images right will win.



Scattergories

Overview: The game is for team members to write down the least common words they can think of starting with a specific letter in certain categories presented on screen in order to win points.

Competency/Skill Target: Vocabulary, Time Management and Social Skills

Time to Complete: 15-20 minutes

Meeting Type : Face-to-Face or virtual

Category: Icebreaker

Instructions:

- Split the team into two evenly sized groups (if playing in-person), for virtual individual participation.
- Facilitator will open the following website and share their screen:
<https://swellgarfo.com/scattergories>
- Set time between 60 – 120 seconds and set category up to 10.
- Click on the reset button and then click play.
- Using the letter and categories provided, players write down the least common words they can think of - 1 word per category.
- Facilitator keeps a tally of points for each team.
- The person with the highest points wins.



Draw, Partner

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Easy Round



Apple



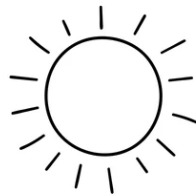
Star



Flower



Half Moon



Sun

Difficult Round



Cup



House



Candle



Mobile Phone



Chair

Thank you for utilizing this resource!

For questions and suggestions, email learningdevelopment@realpage.com